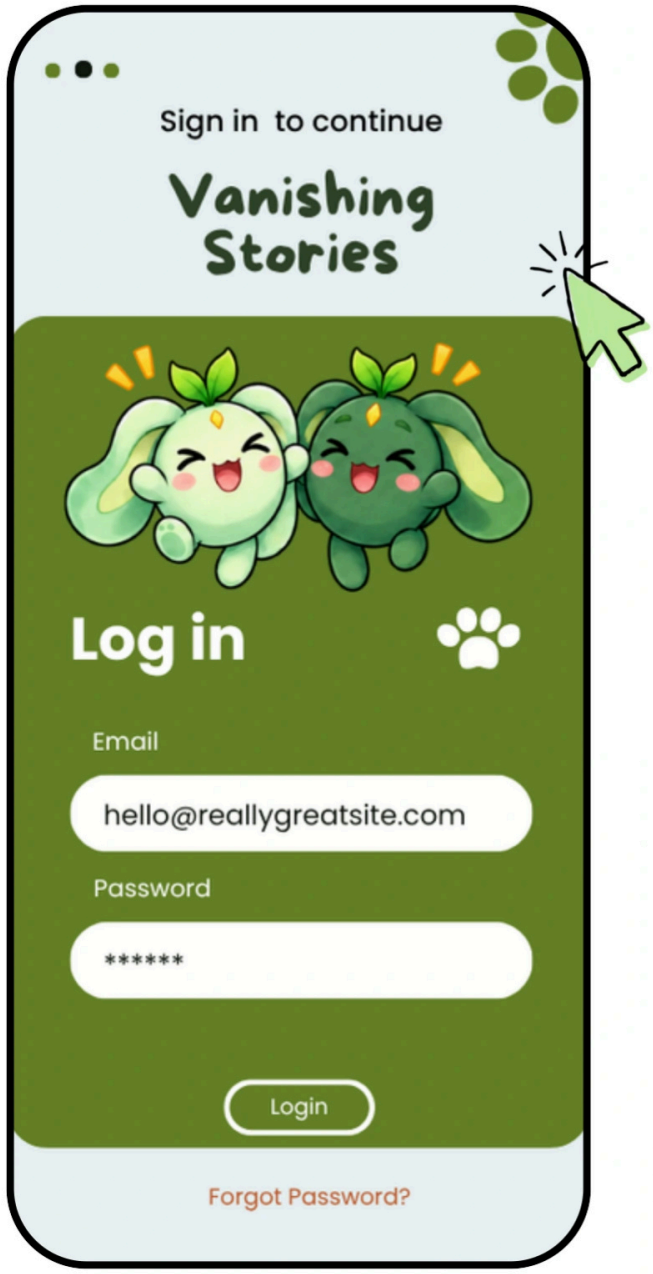

Vanishing
Stories



SHHH... THE STORIES ARE DISAPPEARING!





What is Vanishing stories?

What happens to a **story** when the last person who remembers it is **no longer here** to tell it?

Vanishing Stories is a magical **digital home for stories** at risk of being forgotten. Kids can discover hidden tales, preserve memories, and share their own, because every story deserves to live on.

ONCE UPON A MEMORY...

Some stories are never printed.

They live in a **grandmother's voice**, in a poem recited before bedtime, in a funny family incident or in a **tale** that changes slightly every time it is told. These stories may feel unforgettable, but oral memories are fragile. When they are not **recorded or retold,** they can slowly disappear.



Vanishing Stories asks:

How might we preserve oral childhood memories without removing the warmth, personality and human voice that made them special?

Target Audience:

The platform is designed for both **children** and **adults**. Children experience a playful story world, while parents and grandparents become contributors to a growing cultural archive.





THE BIG IDEA

- **Discover** traditional stories, poems, lullabies and family memories.
- **Listen** to stories in the storyteller's original voice.
- **Read** scripts and translations.
- **Experience** stories as illustrated books or comics.
- **Upload** stories as audio, video, text, photographs or scanned books.
- **Add** personal context such as who told the story and when it was heard.
- **Comment** with another version of the same story.
- Keep sensitive memories **private or share** them with selected family members.
- **Save** stories and cultural artefacts inside a personal profile.
- **Pass** meaningful memories to younger generations.

WHY SHOULD WE CARE ?



Oral traditions include stories, poems, songs, myths, riddles and other knowledge communicated through speech. UNESCO identifies oral traditions and expressions as an important part of intangible cultural heritage. Because they depend on people continuing to practise and transmit them, language loss, migration and social change can place them at risk. UNESCO: Oral Traditions and Expressions

Existing projects also demonstrate that ordinary voices can become important historical records. StoryCorps reports that more than 750,000 people have participated in its conversations, with recordings collected in its online archive and the U.S. Library of Congress. About StoryCorps

However, preservation involves more than pressing a record button. Ethical oral-history practice requires respect for narrators, informed participation, cultural sensitivity and awareness of power between the person recording and the person sharing. Oral History Association Principles and Best Practices

RESEARCH GOAL

How can an interactive digital platform help families preserve oral stories while respecting emotion, ownership, language and privacy?

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

How can a digital platform preserve these memories while making them interesting and accessible for children?

What kinds of stories, poems, rhymes and books did people hear or read during their childhood?

Do people prefer hearing them in an older person's authentic voice or through a clearer, younger narrator?

Why are traditional stories, poems and childhood books slowly disappearing?

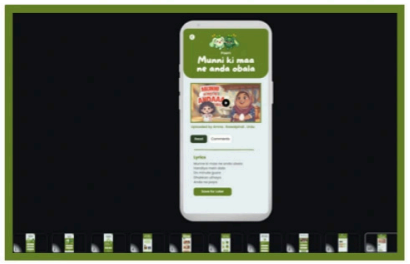


MY ROLE

I shaped Vanishing Stories from an initial idea into a complete digital experience, combining interaction design, storytelling and playful visuals to preserve disappearing childhood memories.

APP & EXPERIENCE DESIGN

I designed the app's interface, user flow and interactive screens, making it simple, engaging and easy for children to explore.



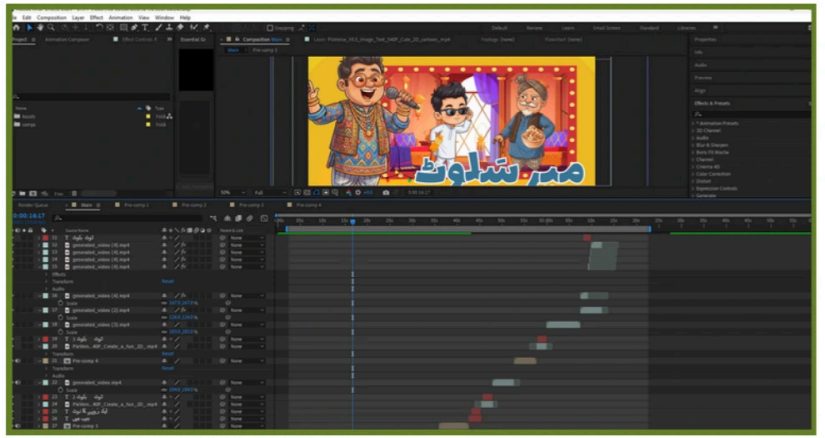


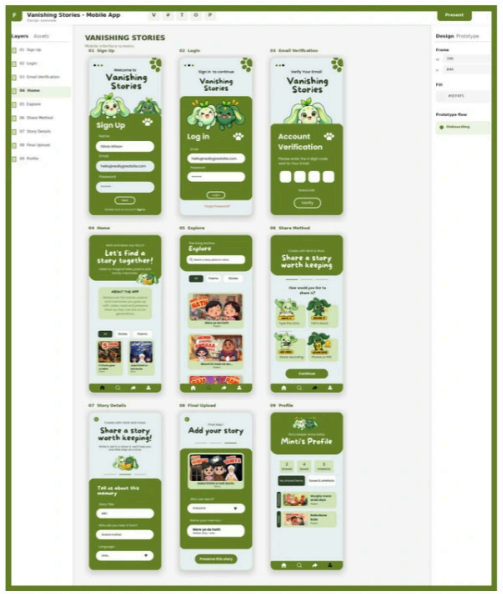
STORIES & POEMS

I researched, collected and adapted traditional stories and poems into digital formats while preserving their original emotions and cultural value.

ANIMATION & INTERACTIONS

I animated the characters, story elements and interface transitions to make the app feel lively and responsive. These animations guide children through the experience while making storytelling more immersive and enjoyable.



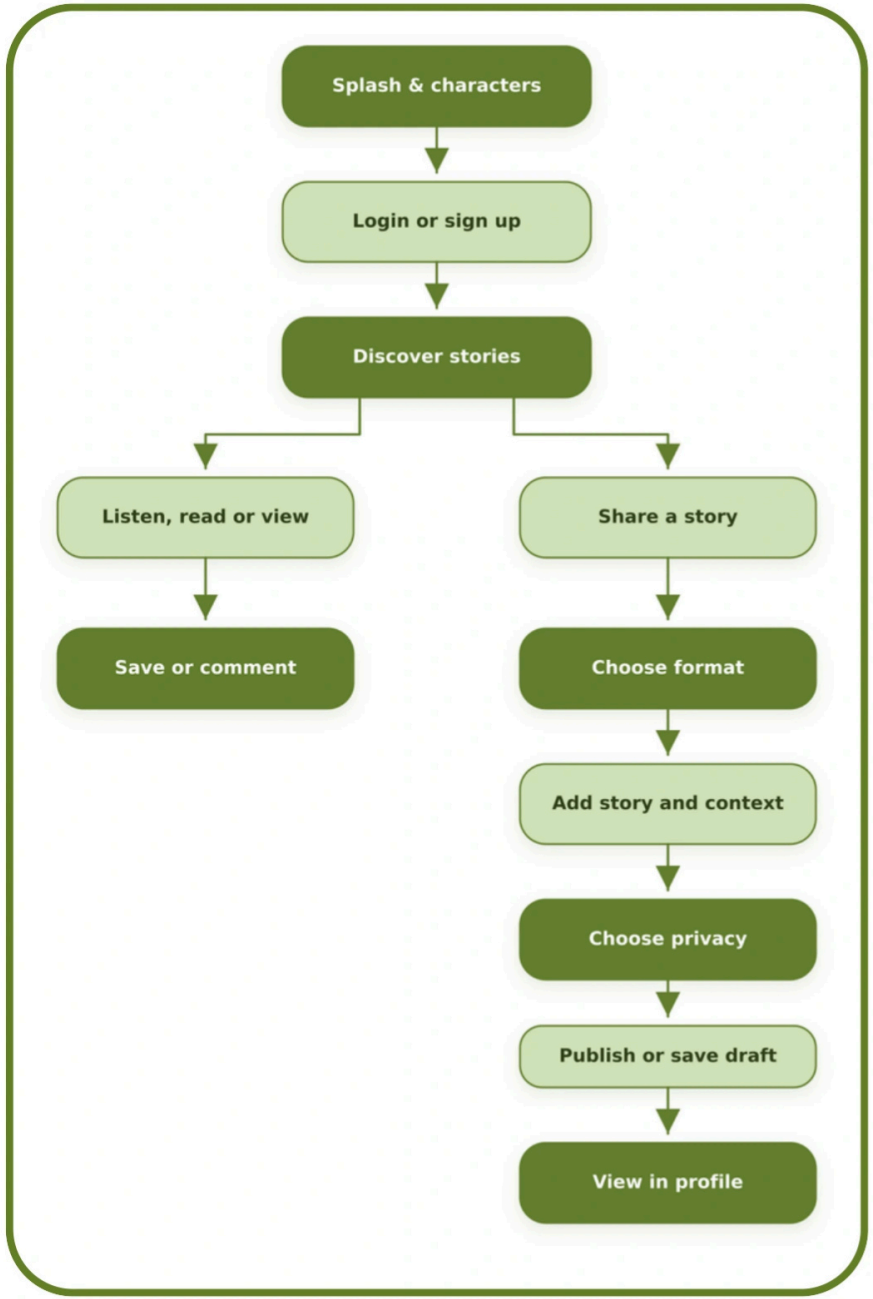


USER FLOW

The user flow guides users from onboarding and discovering stories to listening, reading, or viewing them.

Users can also share their own stories by choosing a format, adding context and privacy settings, then publishing or saving them as drafts.





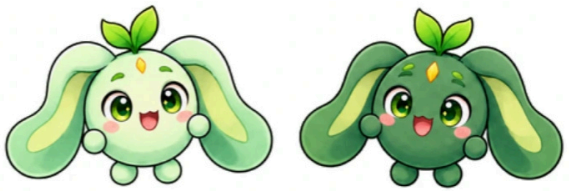
ROUGH UI/UX SKETCHES

Mood Board

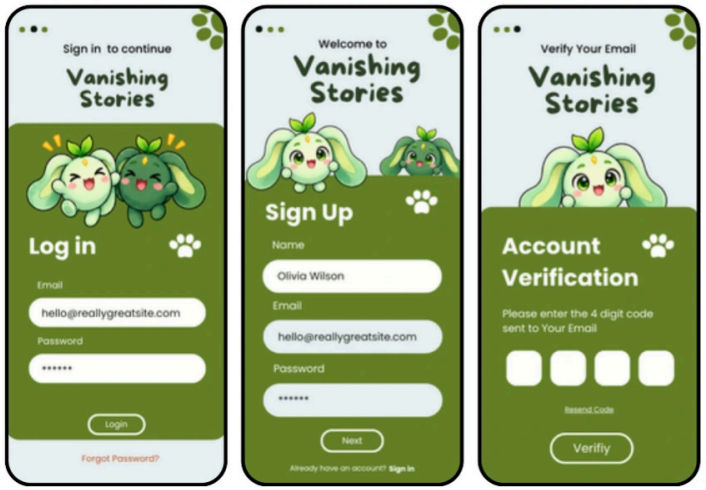
poppins

COMIC SANS



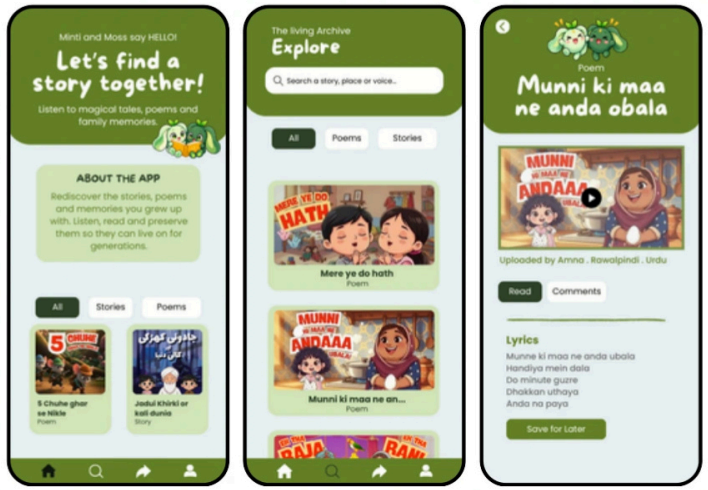


Login screens



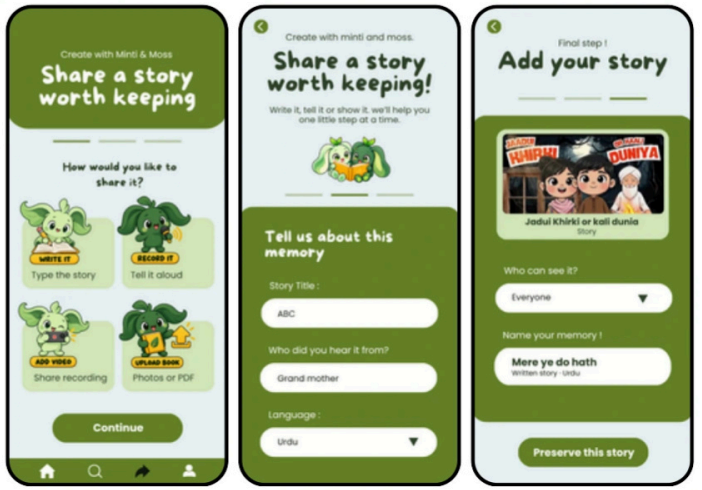
I created these screens to provide users with a simple and welcoming way to sign up, log in and verify their accounts.

Explore Poems & Stories



I designed this section to help users easily discover traditional stories, poems and childhood memories.

Share Stories & Poems



I created this section so users can write, record or upload meaningful stories, poems and books for future generations.



Users Profile

I designed this section to let users manage their shared stories, saved memories, artefacts and drafts in one place.

Characters & Audio

Characters

I created culturally relatable characters for each story, inspired by familiar people, clothing and everyday life within our society.



Audios

I produced playful, funky pop-style poem audio using AI tools, while stories were narrated in elderly male and female voices to recreate the warmth and nostalgia of past storytelling.

